The Dhāraṇī for Purifying Offerings

Toh 1012 · Derge Kangyur
ཡན་ཡངས་སུ་སྦྱང་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī for Purifying Offerings, known in Tibetan as Yon yongs su sbyong ba'i gzungs, is a very brief dhāraṇī text that gives a single incantation for purifying offerings, especially gifts received in faith. The dhāraṇī pays homage to the Tathāgata Sumeru Kalparāja, the "King of Aeons like Mount Meru," and then invokes purification with the words kalpe, kalpe, mahākalpe. The text explains that reciting it just once purifies offerings as vast as Mount Meru, and so it advises reciting it about five or six times. It is Toh 1012 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the short dhāraṇī texts, the class of works preserving spells and incantations for recitation.

Next, the Dhāraṇī for Purifying Offerings:

namo bhagavate sumeru kalparājāya tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya tadyathā oṃ kalpe kalpe mahākalpe kalpa pariśodhani svāhā

It is said that reciting this dhāraṇī once purifies offerings as vast as Mount Meru. Therefore one recites it about five or six times.

The Dhāraṇī for Purifying Offerings is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "Offerings" translates yon, the gifts and donations received from the faithful, such as those given to monastics. The dhāraṇī is meant to purify any karmic burden from accepting such gifts.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.